

Soul, Immortality and Rebirth — MCQ Questions

Coverage-derived question-only practice

Attempt without notes. Answers and explanations are deliberately excluded.

CONTENTS

Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

MCQ 1	3	MCQ 28	7
MCQ 2	3	MCQ 29	7
MCQ 3	3	MCQ 30	7
MCQ 4	3	MCQ 31	7
MCQ 5	3	MCQ 32	8
MCQ 6	3	MCQ 33	8
MCQ 7	4	MCQ 34	8
MCQ 8	4	MCQ 35	8
MCQ 9	4	MCQ 36	8
MCQ 10	4	MCQ 37	9
MCQ 11	4	MCQ 38	9
MCQ 12	4	MCQ 39	9
MCQ 13	5	MCQ 40	9
MCQ 14	5	MCQ 41	9
MCQ 15	5	MCQ 42	9
MCQ 16	5	MCQ 43	10
MCQ 17	5	MCQ 44	10
MCQ 18	5	MCQ 45	10
MCQ 19	6	MCQ 46	10
MCQ 20	6	MCQ 47	10
MCQ 21	6	MCQ 48	10
MCQ 22	6	MCQ 49	11
MCQ 23	6	MCQ 50	11
MCQ 24	6	MCQ 51	11
MCQ 25	7	MCQ 52	11
MCQ 26	7	MCQ 53	11
MCQ 27	7	MCQ 54	12

MCQ 1

On the six survival-terms, which statement is correct?

A. Immortality and survival make exactly the same claim. B. Rebirth is a wider term than reincarnation. C. Liberation is simply a synonym for heaven. D. Resurrection is a form of transmigration.

MCQ 2

Which relation between substantial-soul immortality and rebirth is philosophically defensible?

A. It is neither sufficient by itself nor necessary. B. It is sufficient by itself but not necessary. C. It is necessary but insufficient by itself. D. It is both necessary and sufficient.

MCQ 3

The decisive counter-example to 'rebirth requires an immortal soul' is:

A. Jainism B. Nyaya-Vaisesika C. Buddhism D. Advaita Vedanta

MCQ 4

Calling 'liberation' a family-resemblance term means:

A. It lacks any shared use across philosophical schools. B. It covers distinct destinations linked by overlapping concerns. C. It names precisely the same state in every school. D. It always denotes personal union with a creator-God.

MCQ 5

Plato's recollection (anamnesis) argument most directly establishes:

A. bodily resurrection B. the soul's post-mortem survival on its own C. the soul's pre-existence D. the mortality of the body

MCQ 6

Which is Plato's culminating ('final') argument in the Phaedo?

A. The affinity argument based on likeness to the Forms. B. The cyclical argument based on generation from opposites. C. The final argument based on the Form of Life. D. The recollection argument based on knowledge before birth.

MCQ 7

Simmias objects to Plato that the soul is:

A. a harmony/attunement of the body B. identical with the Forms C. immortal by affinity to the Forms D. a simple substance

MCQ 8

Kant's paralogism, applied to immortality, shows that:

A. The soul's permanence cannot be demonstrated as substantial. B. The soul's survival follows directly from recollected knowledge. C. The soul is known theoretically as an enduring substance. D. The soul is established empirically as a material entity.

MCQ 9

The three kinds of karma are:

A. asrava, bandha and nirjara B. sancita, prarabdha and agami C. jnana, karma and bhakti D. sattva, rajas and tamas

MCQ 10

Rebirth is significant in karma theory chiefly because it:

A. It cancels responsibility once the present life ends. B. It preserves conscious memory of every previous embodiment. C. It lets karmic consequences mature beyond one lifetime. D. It demonstrates a divine distributor of karmic rewards.

MCQ 11

The claim that karma is NOT fatalism rests on:

A. Present effort operates within inherited karmic conditions. B. Unseen karmic force determines every action without remainder. C. Maturing past karma eliminates all present moral choice. D. The subtle body fixes every future action in advance.

MCQ 12

Gita 9.21 (return from heaven once merit is exhausted) shows that:

A. Karmic action has no reality after bodily death. B. Heaven constitutes the final release from saṃsāra. C. Bodily resurrection takes place after heavenly enjoyment. D. Heaven remains a temporary stage within saṃsāra.

MCQ 13

In Buddhism, what is 'reborn' is best described as:

- A. An eternal ātman carrying unchanged personal identity. B. A resurrected body restored by divine action. C. A dependently arisen stream of causally linked events. D. A permanent substance migrating intact between bodies.

MCQ 14

'Neither the same nor wholly other' answers the objection that:

- A. Whether Buddhist analysis collapses into complete nihilism. B. Whether the flame illustration demonstrates rebirth conclusively. C. Who receives karmic fruits if no self persists. D. Whether anātman abolishes all conventional personal reference.

MCQ 15

The flame-to-flame illustration is properly used as:

- A. A model of continuity without strict numerical identity. B. Empirical evidence for an immaterial and immortal soul. C. A demonstrative proof that rebirth actually occurs. D. A demonstrative proof that no self exists.

MCQ 16

The philosophical significance of the anti-theistic stand on rebirth is that rebirth is shown to be:

- A. Logically impossible unless a creator directs the process. B. Coherent without either creator-God or soul-substance. C. Dependent on an immortal bearer governed by God. D. Conceptually identical with bodily resurrection after death.

MCQ 17

In Nyaya apavarga, consciousness in the liberated state is:

- A. absent B. omniscient C. infinite bliss D. non-dual awareness

MCQ 18

Which pair correctly matches liberation-term to school?

- A. nirvana -- Jainism B. kaivalya -- Advaita C. apavarga -- Nyaya-Vaisesika D. moksa -- Buddhism

MCQ 19

Jivanmukti differs from videhamukti in that jivanmukti is:

A. the resurrection of the person B. liberation only after death C. liberation of the body itself D. liberation attained while still embodied

MCQ 20

Griffiths' formula that Advaitic moksha is 'not acquired but acknowledged' means:

A. Mokṣa is acquired later as a heavenly reward. B. Knowledge removes error about an already-free self. C. Ritual action produces mokṣa as a new result. D. Bodily resurrection discloses the self's prior freedom.

MCQ 21

For Viśiṣṭadvaita, in liberation the jīva:

A. The jīva is extinguished when bondage finally ends. B. The jīva persists without awareness or divine relation. C. The jīva persists eternally in communion with God. D. The jīva becomes numerically identical with Brahman.

MCQ 22

The 'real agent' problem is a difficulty primarily for:

A. Advaita B. Viśiṣṭadvaita C. Nyaya D. Jainism

MCQ 23

In Advaita, bondage is fundamentally:

A. avidyā, a beginningless superimposition (adhyāsa) B. karmic matter clinging to the soul C. dependence on God D. the isolation of puruṣa from prakṛti

MCQ 24

For Śaṅkara, the direct means to liberation is:

A. Ritual action that produces liberation as its result. B. Knowledge that removes the ignorance constituting bondage. C. Devotional surrender accepted as an independent direct means. D. Karmic action performed without any need for knowledge.

MCQ 25

In Jainism, the influx of karmic matter into the soul is called:

A. samvara B. bandha C. nirjara D. asrava

MCQ 26

The stoppage of fresh karmic influx is:

A. nirjara B. kevala C. asrava D. samvara

MCQ 27

Jain liberation is best described as:

A. perfected omniscient individuality B. cessation of the causal stream C. identity with Brahman D. contentless isolation of purusa

MCQ 28

Jain kevala differs from Samkhya kaivalya because Jain kevala means:

A. cessation of consciousness B. contentless isolation C. omniscience (kevala-jnana) D. union with a personal God

MCQ 29

Samkhya-karika 62-63 states that, strictly, what is bound and released is:

A. purusa, not prakṛti B. the individual buddhi acting alone C. prakṛti, not purusa D. Isvara

MCQ 30

The potter's-wheel image (SK 67) illustrates:

A. Īśvara continuing creation after discriminative knowledge arises. B. Embodied life continuing through residual karmic momentum. C. Plural puruṣas continuing because each possesses a body. D. World-production continuing through prakṛti's creative activity.

MCQ 31

Yoga-sutra 1.24 characterises Isvara as:

A. a special puruṣa untouched by karma B. identical with prakṛti C. the material cause of the world D. the karmic judge of souls

MCQ 32

Samkhya-Yoga kaivalya is best described as:

A. Non-dual identity of the individual self with Brahman. B. Eternal communion of the individual soul with God. C. Isolation of pure consciousness from all material content. D. Omniscient perfection of an eternally individual soul.

MCQ 33

The nine limbs of devotion (navadha bhakti) are enumerated in:

A. Bhagavad Gītā 18.66 in the surrender teaching. B. Bhāgavata Purāṇa 7.5.23 in Prahlāda's teaching. C. Sāṃkhya-kārikā 62 in the bondage discussion. D. Yoga-sūtra 1.24 in the Īśvara definition.

MCQ 34

Sankara rejects jñāna-karma-samuccaya because he holds that liberation is:

A. Liberation is attained through ritual action alone. B. Liberation is produced as a result of action. C. Liberation requires a graded combination of equal means. D. Liberation removes ignorance rather than producing freedom.

MCQ 35

The marjara-nyaya versus markata-nyaya dispute concerns:

A. How karmic action should be defined across schools. B. How divine grace relates to the aspirant's effort. C. How many distinct puruṣas Sāṃkhya must accept. D. Whether the experienced world possesses ultimate reality.

MCQ 36

The Vivekacudamani definition of bhakti should be attributed to:

A. The Advaita tradition, because personal authorship remains disputed. B. Madhva, because knowledge-grounded devotion defines his path. C. Rāmānuja, because sustained remembrance defines his bhakti. D. Śaṅkara personally, because the attribution is historically certain.

MCQ 37

Oscar Cullmann (1955) argues that immortality of the soul and resurrection of the dead are:

- A. both Greek in origin B. theologically opposed, not complementary C. two names for one doctrine D. both forms of rebirth

MCQ 38

'Reincarnation', in careful usage, differs from 'rebirth' because reincarnation:

- A. is the wider, more neutral term B. presupposes a substantial soul re-entering flesh C. denies any continuity between lives D. applies straightforwardly to Buddhism

MCQ 39

Hick's replica theory is best presented as:

- A. a thought-experiment defence of resurrection identity B. a Vedantic doctrine of liberation C. a proof of the soul's natural immortality D. a denial of personal identity

MCQ 40

Which reply to the resurrection re-assembly problem is correctly paired?

- A. Aquinas -- an exact replica in another space B. Cullmann -- God substitutes a simulacrum C. Hick -- the soul is the form of the body D. van Inwagen -- God preserves a core of the body

MCQ 41

A common error is to say Buddhism denies continuity. Correctly, Buddhism denies:

- A. A permanent substance-self, while retaining causal continuity. B. Moral responsibility, while retaining a permanent substance-self. C. Rebirth itself, while retaining karmic causation in one life. D. Causation itself, while retaining conventional personal identity.

MCQ 42

A frequent trap calls Nyaya apavarga 'positive bliss'. Correctly, apavarga is:

- A. Isolation of puruṣa from the operations of prakṛti. B. Eternal communion of a conscious jīva with God. C. Omniscient perfection of an individual liberated jīva. D. Cessation of pain and cognition-producing qualities while self-substance remains.

MCQ 43

Students merge kaivalya and kevala. In Samkhya kaivalya is ; **in Jainism kevala is** :

A. communion; identity B. omniscience; contentless isolation C. contentless isolation; omniscience D. bliss; cessation

MCQ 44

It is wrong to say 'Advaita rejects bhakti'. Advaita treats bhakti as:

A. Wholly irrelevant to liberation or spiritual qualification. B. A fifth puruṣārtha ranked above liberation itself. C. The direct remover of ignorance in place of knowledge. D. Preparatory purification that qualifies the seeker for knowledge.

MCQ 45

Which option presents a non-theistic liberation model that does not retain an enduring self?

A. Nyāya retains a self-substance after pain and cognition cease. B. Viśiṣṭādvaita retains the eternal jīva in communion with God. C. Advaita realizes the identity of ātman and Brahman through knowledge. D. Buddhism ends craving without positing an enduring self.

MCQ 46

Presenting resurrection as 'rebirth in heaven' is wrong because resurrection is:

A. One embodied life restored by divine action for judgement. B. Many lives generated by karma maturing across embodiments. C. A beginningless series sustained by karmic causal continuity. D. Release from saṃsāra through ending karmic bondage.

MCQ 47

The 'convergence' reading of jnana/karma/bhakti is best defended by saying they converge in ___ and diverge in ___:

A. text; author B. terminus; function C. grace; effort D. function; terminus

MCQ 48

Calling Yoga's Isvara a 'creator' is a trap; YS 1.24 makes Isvara:

A. The material cause from which the world develops. B. The moral judge who allocates every karmic result. C. The same non-dual reality that Advaita calls Brahman. D. A special puruṣa untouched by affliction and karma.

MCQ 49

Which claim correctly distinguishes numerical from qualitative identity in a survival argument?

A. Both terms mean that later memories resemble earlier memories closely. B. Numerical identity preserves one subject; qualitative identity preserves resemblance. C. Numerical identity preserves exact resemblance; qualitative identity preserves one subject. D. Qualitative identity alone preserves one subject across bodily discontinuity.

MCQ 50

Why is branching a problem for a simple psychological-continuity theory of personal identity?

A. Branching shows that only an immortal substantial soul could survive. B. Two equally continuous successors cannot both be the original person. C. Branching shows that later persons cannot remember earlier experiences. D. Branching shows that psychological continuity ends with bodily change.

MCQ 51

What is the central identification-condition pressure on the soul-substance criterion?

A. The criterion must make bodily continuity necessary in every possible case. B. The criterion must reduce resurrection identity to psychological continuity alone. C. The criterion must individuate and re-identify this particular immaterial soul. D. The criterion must deny that any soul could be simple or immaterial.

MCQ 52

In the bounded Strawsonian comparison, why do persons have public identification conditions?

A. Persons are private immaterial egos directly observed by other minds. B. Persons are inferred replicas whose memories alone determine numerical identity. C. Persons are event bundles for which public re-identification is unnecessary. D. Persons are embodied subjects bearing bodily and psychological predicates publicly.

MCQ 53

What follows from Strawson's identification-condition objection when it is used in this Paper II topic?

A. Divine re-creation automatically produces the numerically identical original person. B. A survival claim must explain who survives and how re-identification works. C. Every rebirth doctrine fails because the preceding body eventually perishes. D. Buddhist causal continuity thereby becomes an enduring Cartesian substance.

MCQ 54

Which statement best connects Buddhist rebirth with the diachronic identity debate?

A. Buddhism converts copied memories into an enduring immortal substance. B. Buddhism rejects causal continuity, karma and conventional persons together. C. Buddhism preserves an unchanging owner beneath the changing aggregates. D. Buddhism uses caused continuity that is neither identical nor wholly other.